Answers and talk notes

Fraction Division Problem Solving

What your student is learning

Tonight the hard part is not the arithmetic — it is deciding which number goes FIRST in the division.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **B.** 1/16. One bag gets 1/16 pound, so 1/16 is the size of one group.
2. **A.** 3/4 ÷ 1/4. The total 3/4 cup is split into scoops of 1/4 cup, so 3/4 ÷ 1/4.
3. **D.** 2. 3/4 × 8/3 = 24/12 = 2.
4. **B.** 6. 9/10 × 20/3 = 180/30 = 6.
5. **C.** 5 slices. Five 1/6s make 5/6, so 5 slices fit.

Talk about it

Which number is the total, and which is the size of one group? Does your answer make sense for a "how many" question?

Home mission

Find a cup and a small spoon. Say, "The total is the cup. One group is the spoon." Guess how many spoonfuls fill the cup. Then spoon rice into the cup and count. Which number went first?

When they are stuck, ask

- What is the total amount, and what is one group?
- Which one goes first in the division?
- Does your answer make sense as a number of groups?

Try not to say

- Put the smaller number first, it is easier.
- Any order works, division is flexible.
- A fraction answer is fine for how many pieces.